

Predicting Hypertension (High Blood Pressure) Using Questions

Hypertension (high blood pressure) prediction can be done using structured questions about risk factors, lifestyle, symptoms, and family history. This approach does NOT diagnose but helps estimate the likelihood of hypertension and suggests when medical testing is needed.

Key Categories for Hypertension Screening

Category	Purpose	Example Questions
Demographics	Age/BMI/Sex	What is your age, height, and weight?
Lifestyle	Activity, smoking, alcohol	Do you smoke or drink? How often do you exercise?
Diet	Salt, junk, processed food	Do you eat salty or fast foods frequently?
Symptoms	Warning signs	Do you get headaches, dizziness, or blurred vision?
Family History	Genetic risk	Does anyone in your family have high blood pressure?
Comorbidities	Related conditions	Do you have diabetes, kidney disease, or high cholesterol?
Sleep & Stress	Impact on BP	Do you sleep well? Are you frequently stressed?

Common Warning Signs of Hypertension

Many people with hypertension have no obvious symptoms, but when present, they may include:

- Frequent or severe headaches
- Dizziness or lightheadedness
- Blurred vision
- Shortness of breath on mild exertion
- Chest discomfort or palpitations
- Nosebleeds (in some cases)

Risk Scoring Pattern

Assign scores to responses:

- ✓ Healthy lifestyle, no risk factors: 0
- ✓ One or two mild risk factors (e.g., slightly overweight, occasional junk food): 1–2
- ✓ Multiple strong risk factors (e.g., obesity, smoking, strong family history): 3–5

Risk Levels:

0–3 → Low risk

4–7 → Moderate risk

8+ → High risk — suggest blood pressure measurement and medical evaluation

Include questions like:

- Have you ever been told your BP is high? (Yes → add higher score)
- Do you regularly add extra salt to food? (Yes → add score)

Important:

This questionnaire-based method does not diagnose hypertension. It only helps estimate risk and decide who should get their blood pressure checked soon. A proper diagnosis requires BP measurements on multiple occasions and professional medical evaluation.